

AI Workflow Setup Brief

A practical path for turning one messy recurring workflow into a governed AI workflow a manager can explain, test, approve, and improve.

The point is not broad AI transformation.

The point is one useful workflow with clear scope, approved inputs, source support, human approval, stop rules, and a measured pilot path.

Where Optimism fits

Good first workflow	Weak first workflow	Buyer pattern
Repeated work with review burden, stable sources, and visible rework, delay, or risk.	Vague AI training, autonomous production action, unclear data boundaries, or no named owner.	An operating owner, technical or security reviewer, operator, and output reviewer.

The operating controls

Scope One workflow, output, owner, and review point.	Data Approved inputs, prohibited data, retention, and access limits.
Tools Allowed tools, blocked actions, permissions, and change control.	Evidence Source register, assumptions, exceptions, and traceable claims.
Approval Named human review before business action.	Recovery Stop conditions, incidents, rollback, and handoff rules.

How the engagement moves

1. Workflow Fit Call	Confirm the workflow, buyer pattern, data boundary, and first useful metric.
2. AI Governance Setup	Create the manager-readable work package, run the GOV acceptance gate, and decide whether the workflow is pilot-ready.
3. Implementation Sprint	Build the governed workflow with source support, evaluation checks, approval path, training, and rollback plan.
4. Operations Retainer	Track drift, changes, proof metrics, risks, access, and adjacent workflow opportunities.

PROOF AND NEXT STEP

Governance becomes useful when it is testable.

Optimism's governance kit gives the workflow a visible operating spine: manager brief, data policy, risk register, evaluation plan, run log, change control, and acceptance tests.

What the GOV gate proves

GOV-001 Baseline package is complete, internally linked, and manager-readable.	GOV-002/003 Data handling and tool permissions are explicitly bounded before implementation.	GOV-004/005 Source evidence and manager handoff are reviewable before pilot use.
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Modeled ExampleCo demo

Before	Spreadsheet-heavy commission packet review with unclear scope, no formal data boundary, weak approval trace, and inconsistent evidence.
After setup	A governed work package defines owners, approved inputs, approval gates, risk controls, evaluation checks, source records, and manager stop rules.
Modeled pilot signal	Manager prep time down 66%, rework down 12 points, approval trace complete, and unresolved high risks closed before pilot. Synthetic demo metrics, not client production claims.

The six proof metrics

Time saved	Approval speed	Error reduction
Evidence quality	Risk findings closed	Repeat usage

Next step: bring one workflow.

A 20-minute Workflow Fit Call should answer whether the workflow is specific enough, valuable enough, and controlled enough to justify a fixed-scope AI Governance Setup.

Source basis: Optimism sales value deck, GOV-001 demo deck, ExampleCo synthetic case study, AI Agent Working Group Governance Kit, and proof-metrics playbook.